

Apocorophium lacustre

(scud)

Crustaceans-Amphipods

Native Transplant

 Collection Info

 Point Map

 Species Profile

 Animated Map

Apocorophium lacustre (Vanhoffen, 1911)

Common name: scud

Taxonomy: available through 

Native Range:



[Hydrologic Unit Codes \(HUCs\) Explained](#)
Interactive maps: [Point Distribution Maps](#)

Nonindigenous Occurrences:

Table 1. States with nonindigenous occurrences, the earliest and latest observations in each state, and the tally and names of [HUCs](#) with observations†. Names and dates are hyperlinked to their relevant specimen records. The list of references for all nonindigenous occurrences of *Apocorophium lacustre* are found [here](#).

State	First Observed	Last Observed	Total HUCs with observations†	HUCs with observations†
IL	2002	2025	7	Des Plaines ; Highland-Pigeon ; Lower Illinois ; Lower Illinois-Lake Chautauqua ; Lower Ohio-Bay ; Upper Illinois ; Upper Mississippi-Cape Girardeau
IN	2005	2010	5	Blue-Sinking ; Highland-Pigeon ; Lower Ohio-Little Pigeon ; Middle Ohio-Laughery ; Silver-Little Kentucky
KY	2004	2010	8	Blue-Sinking ; Highland-Pigeon ; Little Scioto-Tygarts ; Lower Ohio-Bay ; Lower Ohio-Little Pigeon ; Middle Ohio-Laughery ; Ohio Brush-Whiteoak ; Silver-Little Kentucky
MO	2006	2006	1	Upper Mississippi-Cape Girardeau
OH	2005	2010	5	Little Scioto-Tygarts ; Middle Ohio-Laughery ; Ohio Brush-Whiteoak ; Raccoon-Symmes ; Upper Ohio-Shade
PA	2008	2008	1	Upper Ohio
WV	2005	2010	4	Little Muskingum-Middle Island ; Raccoon-Symmes ; Upper Ohio-Shade ; Upper Ohio-Wheeling

Table last updated 12/8/2025

† Populations may not be currently present.

Ecology: Habitat

In its native habitat (Rhine River), *Apocorophium lacustre* is found in lower littoral and sublittoral regions and on boulder (10-50 cm diameter) substrate (Faasse and van Moorsel 2003). Distribution patterns suggest that *A. lacustre* is associated with greater depths and faster water velocity (Krodkiewska et al. 2020). In the Upper Mississippi River, *A. lacustre* was found associated with hard, stable substrates such as rocks and snags; in the Ohio River, where cobble and boulder habitats were less available, it colonized primarily sand and snags. This species is epibenthic and typically associated with inorganic substrates, aquatic vegetation, or zebra mussel colonies (Grigorovich et al. 2008).

Scuds are found in waters with DO ranging from 1.2-6.9 mg/L (Llansó and Sillett 2009). *Apocorophium lacustre* is described as salt-tolerant (Evans et al. 2004), from 0-30 ppt (Wolf et al. 2009), and euryhaline, but it tends to be found in the least saline environments (Faasse and van Moorsel 2003). *A. lacustre* has been observed in areas with mean water temperatures as low as 1°C and as high as 31.4°C (Harmeson and Schnepper 1965; Llansó and Sillett 2009).

Food Web

Apocorophium lacustre is a detritus, suspension, and surface-deposit feeder (Llansó and Sillett 2009; Power et al. 2006) making it a moderately dietary generalist with a flexible diet. Gut content analysis indicates that its diet is composed of bacteria, protozoa, algae, and detritus (Quebbeman and Keller 2023). *A. lacustre* is a suitable prey item for many aquatic predators, from the micro-predator flatworm *Euplana gracilis* to the shovelnose sturgeon *Scaphirhynchus platyrhynchus* (Seibert et al. 2011; Janiak et al. 2017). *A. lacustre* has the potential to alter food webs through competition with native mussels for food and habitat (USACE 2013; Barrera et al. 2020).

Life History

Apocorophium lacustre reproduces sexually and is sexually dimorphic, with males larger than females. The male locates potential partners using antennae to detect pheromones, riding or carrying the female until she is ready to molt (Ruppert et al. 2004). Like other amphipods, *A. lacustre* broods its young in the marsupium, a strategy associated with enhanced colonization success. Embryos brood on the female’s underside and hatch out as crawling juveniles (USACE 2013). Individuals undergo a maximum of 20 molts and have a one-year-long life cycle (Ruppert et al. 2004).

References (click for full references)

Grigorovich, I.A., T.R. Angradi, E.B. Emery, and M.S. Wooten. 2008. Invasion of the upper Mississippi River system by saltwater amphipods. Fundamental and Applied Limnology 173(1):67-77.

Other Resources:

[GBIF Backbone Taxonomy Profile](#)

[US Fish and Wildlife Service Ecological Risk Screening Summary for Apocorophium lacustre](#)

Author: Benson, A.J., A. Fusaro, A. Davidson, K. Alame, M. Gappy, W. Conard, R. Sturtevant, and C. Shelly

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